

# **INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (UTA025)**

Submitted by

Harnoor Singh (102483027)

Himesh Jindal (102483029)

Janak Arora(102483031)

Jasjot Singh (102483032)

**Group No. : 3C74\_2**  
**Project Title: CampusCrate**

**Course Instructor(s) : Dr. Pravindra Kumar**

**LECTURE FACULTY & LAB FACULTY**



**THAPAR INSTITUTE**  
OF ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY  
(Deemed to be University)

**VENTURE LAB,**  
**THAPAR INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY, PATIALA**

**Session: (JAN-MAY, 2026)**

**(Date of submission: 01/05/2026)**

## Contents

|                                                                 |    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Chapter 1: Opportunity Analysis .....                           | 4  |
| 1.1 Opportunity Identification .....                            | 4  |
| 1.2 Solution Proposed .....                                     | 4  |
| 1.3 Uniqueness of the Solution .....                            | 4  |
| 1.4 Problem Solved for the Market Segment .....                 | 5  |
| 1.5 Identification of Users and Customers .....                 | 5  |
| 1.6 Benefits to Target Users .....                              | 5  |
| 1.7 User Discovery and Adoption Strategy .....                  | 5  |
| 1.8 Impact on the Market Segment .....                          | 6  |
| Chapter 2: Customer Validation Survey .....                     | 7  |
| 2.1 Sample form used for customer survey .....                  | 7  |
| 2.2 Size of the customer survey and its documentary proof ..... | 12 |
| 2.4 Detailed Analysis of the survey .....                       | 17 |
| 2.5 Conclusion of the survey .....                              | 20 |
| Chapter 3: Financial Model .....                                | 21 |
| 3.1 Cost Structure .....                                        | 21 |
| 3.2 Revenue Structure .....                                     | 21 |
| 3.3 Profit & Loss Statement .....                               | 22 |
| 3.4 Cash Flow Statement .....                                   | 22 |
| Chapter 4: Reflections .....                                    | 23 |
| Annexures .....                                                 | 24 |
| 1.Opportunity canvas .....                                      | 24 |
| 2.Business model canvas .....                                   | 25 |

# CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project report on, “*CampusCrate (GROUP NO 2)*” being submitted by **Mr. Himesh Jindal, Mr. Janak Arora, Mr. Jasjot Singh, Mr. Harnoor Singh** to the Venture Lab, Thapar Institute of Engineering and Technology, Patiala for the fulfilment of the course requirement of **INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (UTA025)** is a bonafide record of work carried out by us in conformity with the rules and regulations of the institute.

The results presented in this report have not been submitted, in part or full, to any other University or Institute for the award of any degree or diploma.

Dated: 1-may-2026

Harnoor Singh (102483027)  
Himesh Jindal (102483029)  
Janak Arora (102483031)  
Jasjot Singh (102483032)

# **Chapter 1: Opportunity Analysis**

## **1.1 Opportunity Identification**

The opportunity for CampusCrate arises from a persistent and recurring problem within college and university hostels. Students frequently undergo transitions such as admissions, room changes, semester breaks, and graduation, during which they need to buy or sell essential items like furniture, electronics, books, and daily-use goods. However, existing methods such as WhatsApp groups, Telegram channels, and external platforms like OLX or Facebook Marketplace are unorganized, unreliable, and often unsafe. These channels lack verification mechanisms, structured listings, and dispute resolution systems, leading to problems such as scams, poor coordination, time wastage, and inconvenience. Additionally, many usable items are abandoned or discarded, contributing to waste and clutter within hostels. Hostel administrations also face challenges in managing leftover items and space utilization. This situation clearly indicates a gap in the market for a structured, trustworthy, and campus-specific exchange system that can streamline transactions and improve efficiency .

---

## **1.2 Solution Proposed**

CampusCrate proposes a comprehensive solution in the form of a campus-based digital marketplace integrated with a physical exchange and storage hub. The platform enables verified hostel users to list items for sale, browse available products, and complete transactions securely. It incorporates an escrow-based payment system to ensure that payments are released only after successful delivery, thereby reducing fraud. A QR-based pickup mechanism allows buyers to collect items efficiently without direct interaction, ensuring convenience and safety. Additionally, the platform offers optional storage services for students who wish to temporarily store items during transitions. The inclusion of digital ownership records further enhances transparency and accountability. By combining technology with physical infrastructure, CampusCrate provides a seamless and reliable transaction experience.

---

## **1.3 Uniqueness of the Solution**

The uniqueness of CampusCrate lies in its hybrid model that integrates both digital and physical components within a closed campus ecosystem. Unlike conventional online marketplaces, it restricts access to verified hostel users, thereby significantly reducing the risk of fraudulent activities. The escrow payment system ensures secure financial transactions, while the QR-based pickup system introduces a modern, contactless exchange method. Furthermore, the presence of a physical hub for verification, storage, and exchange of goods addresses logistical challenges that purely digital platforms fail to solve. The platform also focuses on community building within the campus, creating a trusted and localized marketplace. This combination of trust, convenience, and operational efficiency distinguishes CampusCrate from existing alternatives.

---

## **1.4 Problem Solved for the Market Segment**

CampusCrate effectively addresses multiple pain points faced by students and hostel administrations. It eliminates the risk of scams and fraud through user verification and escrow payments. It simplifies the buying and selling of bulky items, which are otherwise difficult to exchange through informal channels. The platform reduces time and effort by providing a centralized and organized system for transactions. It also helps in minimizing waste by promoting the reuse of items, thereby contributing to sustainability. For hostel administrations, it provides a structured way to manage abandoned items and optimize space utilization. Overall, the solution enhances convenience, safety, and efficiency for the entire market segment.

---

## **1.5 Identification of Users and Customers**

The primary users of CampusCrate are students residing in hostels, including freshers, mid-year students, and final-year students. Freshers typically act as buyers as they need to set up their living spaces, while final-year students act as sellers as they prepare to leave the campus. Mid-year students participate as both buyers and sellers depending on their needs. Secondary users include hostel administration and faculty members who may use the platform for managing or acquiring items. This diverse user base ensures a continuous cycle of demand and supply, making the platform sustainable and active throughout the academic year.

---

## **1.6 Benefits to Target Users**

CampusCrate offers significant benefits to its users. Students gain access to affordable second-hand items, helping them reduce their overall expenses. Sellers can conveniently dispose of their belongings without the stress of finding buyers through informal channels. The platform ensures secure and trustworthy transactions, reducing the risk of fraud. It also saves time by providing a centralized marketplace where all transactions can be managed efficiently. Additionally, the solution promotes environmental sustainability by encouraging the reuse and recycling of items. The presence of a physical hub further enhances reliability and ease of use.

---

## **1.7 User Discovery and Adoption Strategy**

The adoption of CampusCrate will be driven through a combination of digital and on-campus strategies. The primary channel will be the mobile application or web platform, supported by promotion through WhatsApp and Telegram hostel groups. Awareness will be created through hostel notice boards, posters, and campus events, especially during peak periods such as the beginning and end of semesters. Campus ambassadors will play a key role in promoting the platform among students. Referral programs and incentives will encourage early adoption and user engagement. Collaboration with hostel administration will further build trust and legitimacy, ensuring wider acceptance of the platform.

---

## **1.8 Impact on the Market Segment**

CampusCrate is expected to bring a significant transformation to the campus marketplace ecosystem. It will replace informal and unstructured transaction methods with a secure, organized, and efficient system. The platform will reduce clutter and waste within hostels by facilitating the reuse of items. It will also improve student satisfaction by providing a convenient and reliable solution for buying and selling goods. Over time, the platform can create strong network effects, where an increase in users leads to higher value for all participants. Additionally, the model has the potential to scale across multiple campuses, thereby expanding its impact and creating a standardized solution for campus-based marketplaces.

# Chapter 2: Customer Validation Survey

## 2.1 Sample form used for customer survey

**Name**  
  

Your answer

**Year of Study**  
  

☐ 1st

☐ 2nd

☐ 3rd

☐ 4th

☐ Passed

**Have you ever bought or sold items within your college?**  
  

☐ Yes

☐ No

**Would you be interested in selling or buying items in your campus?**  
  

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Maybe

**Where do you currently buy/sell items?**  
  

☐ WhatsApp groups

☐ Telegram

☐ OLX

☐ Facebook Marketplace

☐ Friends / Word of Mouth

☐ Other

**What type of items do you usually deal with?**

- ☐ Books
- ☐ Electronics
- ☐ Furniture
- ☐ Clothes
- ☐ Notes / Study Material
- ☐ Other

**What problems have you faced while buying/selling?**

- ☐ Fake listings
- ☐ No trust between buyers/sellers
- ☐ Payment fraud
- ☐ No proper platform
- ☐ Hard to find relevant items
- ☐ Other

**How important is trust/security in such transactions?**

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4

**Would you use a dedicated student marketplace app?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Maybe
- ☐ No



**Which features would you like?**

- ☐ Verified student accounts
- ☐ In-app chat
- ☐ Secure payment (escrow)
- ☐ Rating/review system
- ☐ Search & filters
- ☐ Delivery options
- ☐ Other

**Have you ever faced problems while hauling large goods while changing hostel or going Home in Breaks?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe

**Would You be interested in a service that helps you moving stuff?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe

**Would you be interested if a service is provided to keep your goods safe while you are home ?**

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe

**When would you usually need storage?**

- ☐ Semester breaks
- ☐ Hostel shifting
- ☐ Internships / going home
- ☐ Traveling
- ☐ Other: \_\_\_\_\_

**What items would you store?**

- ☐ Books & notes
- ☐ Clothes
- ☐ Electronics
- ☐ Furniture (chair, table, etc.)
- ☐ Luggage
- ☐ Other: \_\_\_\_\_

**What would make storage services useful for you?**

- ☐ Pickup from hostel/room
- ☐ Doorstep delivery back
- ☐ Flexible duration
- ☐ Affordable pricing
- ☐ Secure handling
- ☐ Tracking system

**How long would you typically need storage?**

- ☐ Less than 1 week
- ☐ 1–4 weeks
- ☐ 1–3 months
- ☐ More than 3 months

**What concerns would you have about using a storage service?**

- ☐ Damage to items
- ☐ Theft/loss
- ☐ Hidden charges
- ☐ Delayed return
- ☐ Lack of tracking
- ☐ Other

**What features would increase your trust?**

- ☐ Insurance coverage
- ☐ Item photos before storage
- ☐ QR/barcode tracking
- ☐ Verified service providers
- ☐ Reviews/ratings
- ☐ CCTV monitored storage

**How much would you be willing to pay for storage per month?**

- ☐ ₹100–₹300
- ☐ ₹300–₹700
- ☐ ₹700–₹1500
- ☐ Depends on items

**Would you prefer:**

- ☐ App only
- ☐ Website only
- ☐ Both

Any Suggestions or Feedback for us :

Your answer

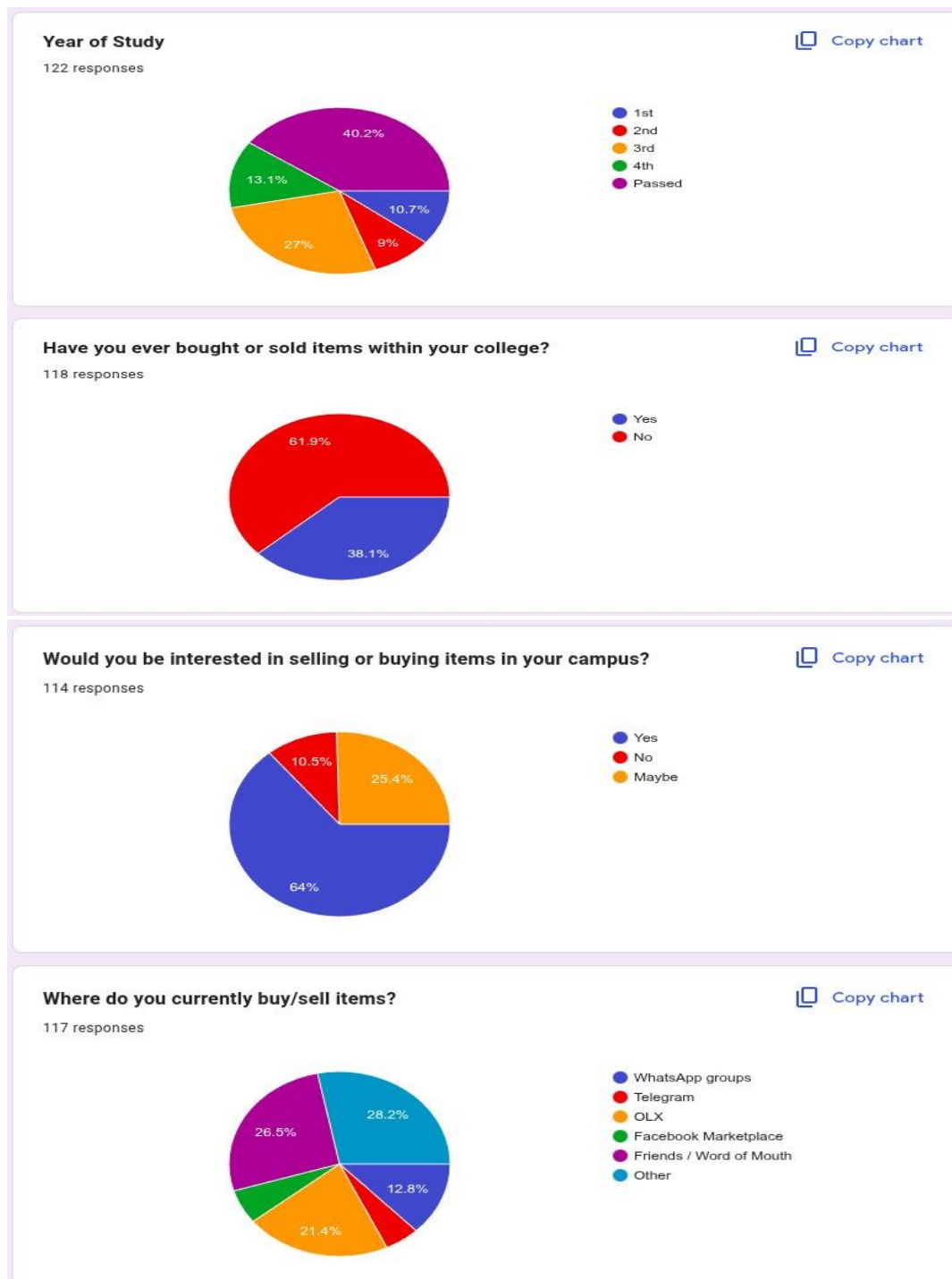
Submit

Clear form

## 2.2 Size of the customer survey and its documentary proof

To get a customer survey, we published and circulated a google form. We recorded 123 responses where all the survey responses were filled by the end-user i.e. people belonging to different domains for holistic and well-distributed survey results.

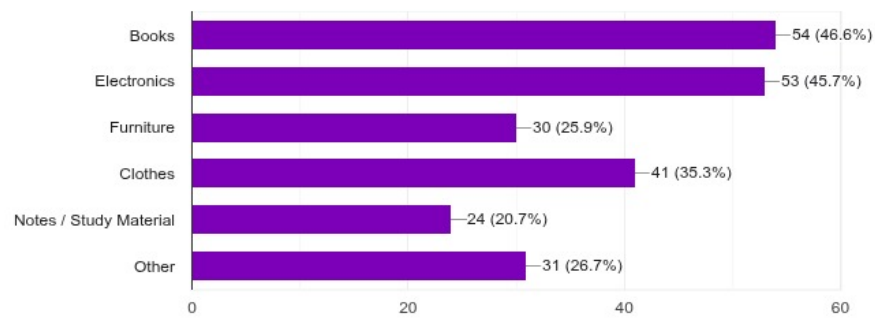
### 2.3 Results of the survey (question wise)



### What type of items do you usually deal with?

 [Copy chart](#)

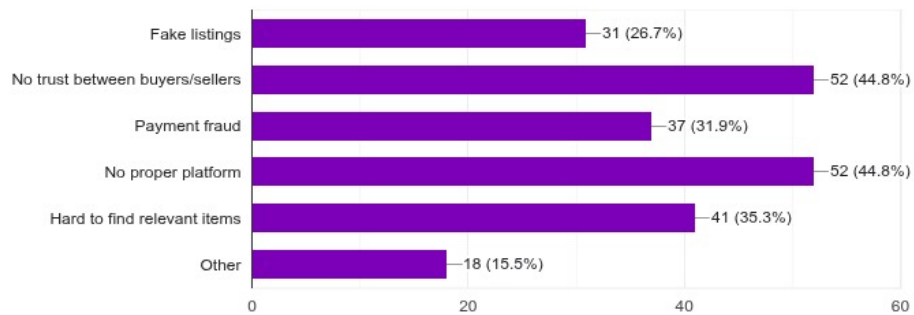
116 responses



### What problems have you faced while buying/selling?

 [Copy chart](#)

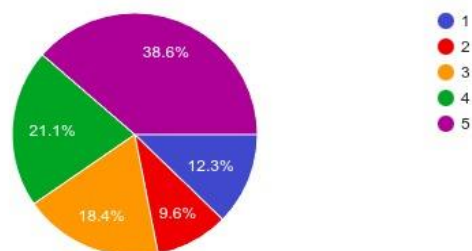
116 responses



### How important is trust/security in such transactions?

 [Copy chart](#)

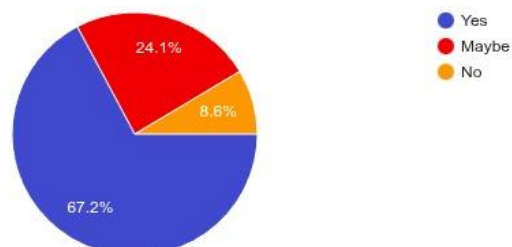
114 responses



### Would you use a dedicated student marketplace app?

 [Copy chart](#)

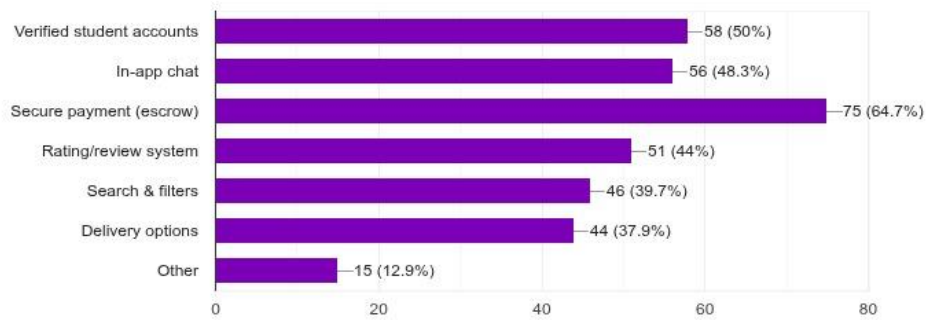
116 responses



### Which features would you like?

 [Copy chart](#)

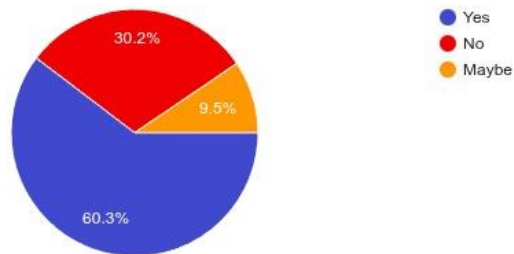
116 responses



### Have you ever faced problems while hauling large goods while changing hostel or going Home in Breaks?

 [Copy chart](#)

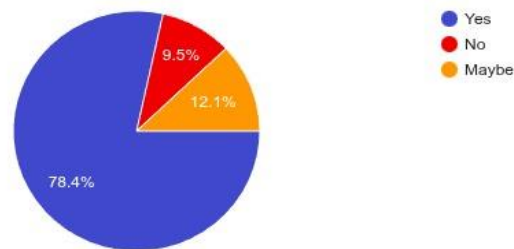
116 responses



### Would You be interested in a service that helps you moving stuff?

 [Copy chart](#)

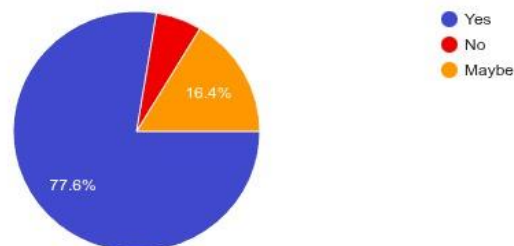
116 responses



### Would you be interested if a service is provided to keep your goods safe while you are home ?

 [Copy chart](#)

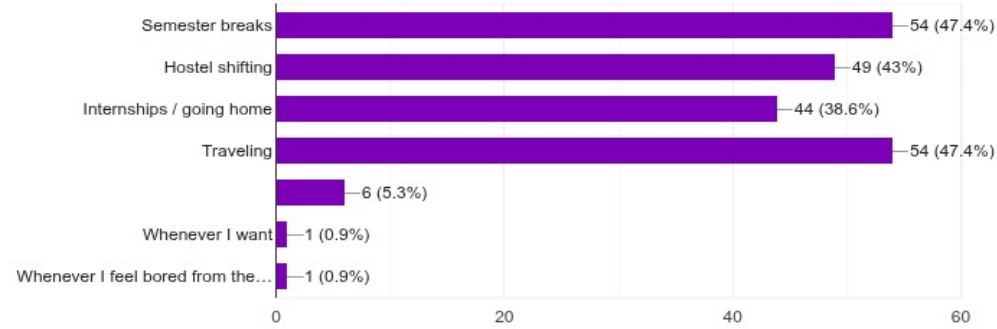
116 responses



### When would you usually need storage?

[Copy chart](#)

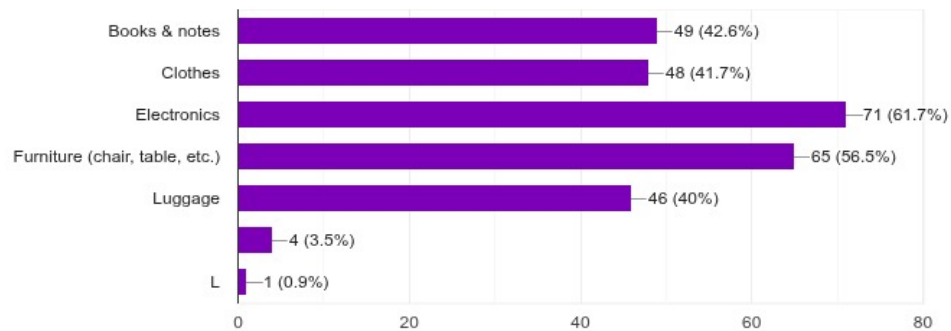
114 responses



### What items would you store?

[Copy chart](#)

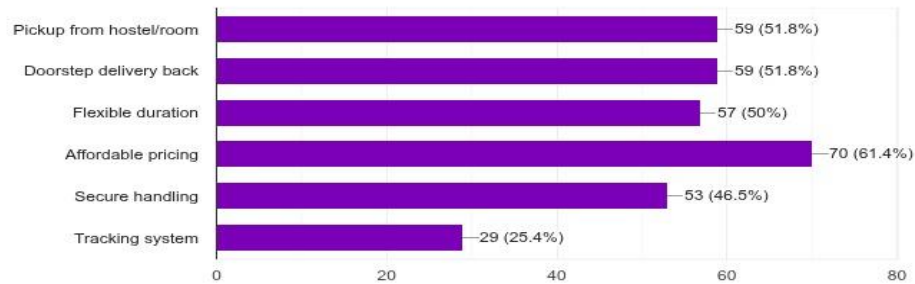
115 responses



### What would make storage services useful for you?

[Copy chart](#)

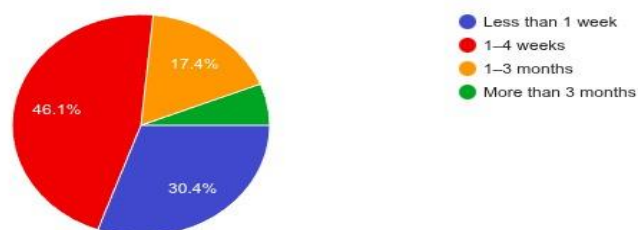
114 responses



### How long would you typically need storage?

[Copy chart](#)

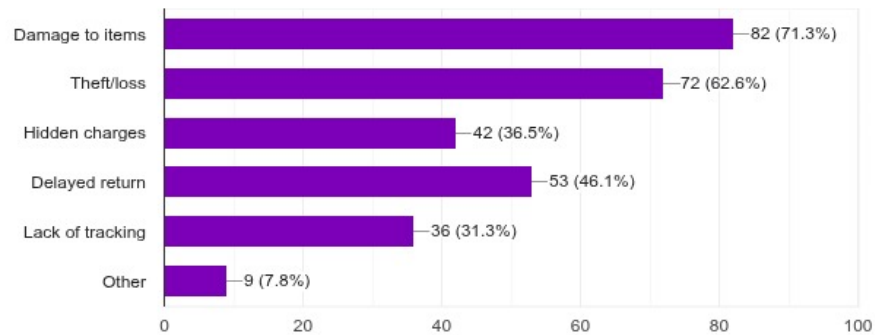
115 responses



### What concerns would you have about using a storage service?

 [Copy chart](#)

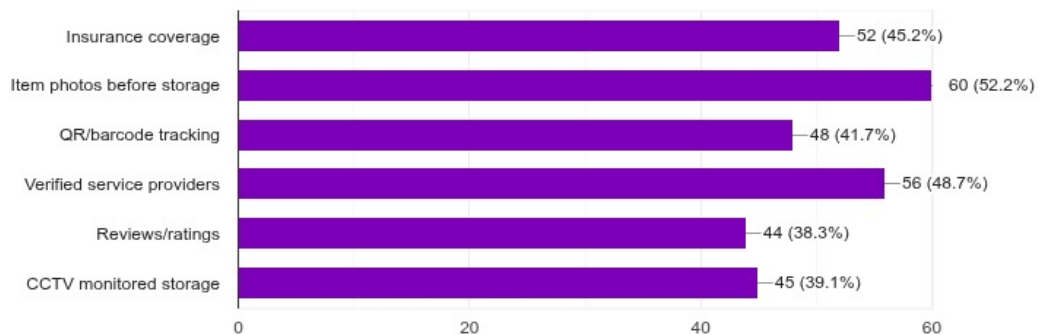
115 responses



### What features would increase your trust?

 [Copy chart](#)

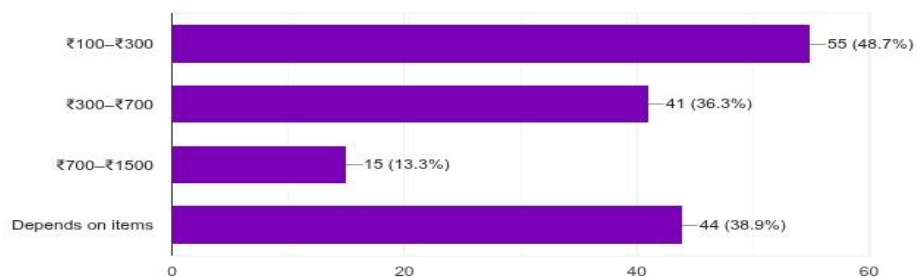
115 responses



### How much would you be willing to pay for storage per month?

 [Copy chart](#)

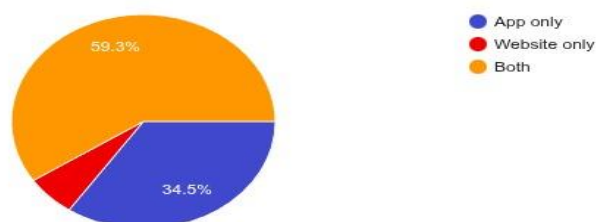
113 responses



### Would you prefer:

 [Copy chart](#)

113 responses





## 2.4 Detailed Analysis of the survey

### 1. Audience Profile

- Passed out students: 40.2%
- 3rd year: ~27%
- 4th year: ~13%
- 1st & 2nd year: smaller share
- Target users: final-year students, hostel residents, alumni  
Explanation: Most respondents are experienced students who have already faced buying, selling, and shifting issues, making them ideal early adopters.

### 2. Marketplace Behavior

- 61.9% never bought/sold
- 64% interested, 25% maybe
- Current platforms: WhatsApp, OLX, friends, Facebook
- Market type: fragmented, unmet demand  
Explanation: There is strong interest but low participation due to lack of a proper system, indicating a clear opportunity.

### 3. Top Product Categories

- Books: 46.6%
- Electronics: 45.7%
- Clothes: 35%
- Furniture: 25.9%  
Explanation: These are essential and frequently exchanged items, especially during academic cycles and hostel shifting.

### 4. Core Problems

- No trust: 44.8%
- No proper platform: 44.8%
- Payment fraud: 31.9%
- Hard to find items: 35.3%
- Fake listings: 26.7%  
Explanation: The biggest barrier is trust, not demand, which your platform needs to solve.

### 5. Product Validation

- High importance of trust (rated 4–5)
- 67.2% willing to use dedicated app  
Explanation: Users are ready to adopt a solution if it is reliable and secure.

## **6. MVP Features**

- Secure payment
- Verified accounts
- In-app chat
- Ratings & reviews
- Search & filters

Explanation: These features directly address trust and usability, which are critical for initial success.

## **7. Logistics Demand**

- 60.3% faced transport issues
- 78.4% want moving help
- 77.6% want storage

Explanation: Students struggle with moving items, creating a strong opportunity beyond just a marketplace.

## **8. Storage Usage**

- Use cases: semester breaks, travel, hostel shifting
- Items: electronics, furniture, books, clothes

Explanation: Storage demand is seasonal and tied to student mobility.

## **9. Storage Concerns**

- Damage: 71.3%
- Theft/loss: 62.6%
- Delay: 46.1%

Explanation: Safety and reliability are major concerns that must be addressed to build trust.

## **10. Trust Features (Storage)**

- Item photos
- Verified providers
- Insurance
- CCTV

Explanation: These features reduce risk perception and increase user confidence in storage services.

## **11. Pricing Preference**

- ₹100–₹300: 48.7%
- ₹300–₹700: 36.3%
- Needs flexible/tiered pricing

Explanation: Students are price-sensitive, so affordable and flexible pricing is essential.

## **12. Platform Preference**

- Both app + website: 58.3%
- App only: 34.5%

Explanation: A combination of web and app ensures both accessibility and engagement.

## **Final Model**

- Marketplace (buy/sell): Enables students to exchange items within campus
  - Logistics (pickup/delivery): Solves transportation and shifting issues
  - Storage (short-term): Provides safe space during breaks and transitions
- Explanation: The startup should function as a complete student ecosystem combining transactions, movement, and storage.

## 2.5 Conclusion of the survey

The survey clearly indicates a strong unmet need for a dedicated student-focused platform that combines buying, selling, logistics, and storage services. While a majority of students have not actively participated in marketplace transactions, a large percentage show clear interest, highlighting a latent demand waiting to be unlocked.

The core issue across all areas—marketplace, moving, and storage—is lack of trust. Concerns around fraud, fake listings, item safety, and unreliable services prevent students from engaging in existing solutions. This creates a significant opportunity for a platform that prioritizes verification, secure payments, transparency, and accountability.

Additionally, the high demand for moving and storage services reveals that the problem extends beyond transactions. Students face real challenges during hostel shifting, semester breaks, and travel, making logistics and storage essential components of the solution rather than optional add-ons.

The findings also show that students are price-sensitive but willing to pay for convenience and safety if the service is reliable. A simple, trustworthy, and affordable platform available on both web and mobile is most likely to achieve strong adoption.

Overall, the survey validates the potential of building an integrated student ecosystem that combines a trusted marketplace with logistics and storage solutions. The success of the startup will depend on solving trust issues, focusing on core features, and targeting experienced student segments as early users.

## Chapter 3: Financial Model

### 3.1 Cost Structure

| Metric                  | Year 1<br>(2025-26) | Year 2<br>(2026-27) | Year 3<br>(2027-28) |
|-------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Users                   | 2,000               | 2,800               | 3,920               |
| Total Revenue (₹ Lakhs) | 9.50                | 13.38               | 18.93               |
| Total Cost (₹ Lakhs)    | 8.95                | 10.50               | 14.50               |
| Gross Profit (₹ Lakhs)  | 0.55                | 2.88                | 4.43                |
| Gross Profit Margin (%) | 5.8%                | 21.6%               | 23.4%               |
| Net Profit (₹ Lakhs)    | 0.55                | 2.88                | 4.43                |
| Net Profit Margin (%)   | 5.8%                | 21.6%               | 23.4%               |

### 3.2 Revenue Structure

| Revenue Stream               | Year 1<br>(2025-26) | Year 2<br>(2026-27) | Year 3<br>(2027-28) |
|------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Storage (₹350 per user)      | 7.00                | 9.80                | 13.72               |
| Transaction Fee              | 1.50                | 2.10                | 2.94                |
| Premium Listings (10% Users) | 0.70                | 0.98                | 1.37                |
| Ads                          | 0.30                | 0.50                | 0.90                |
| Total Revenue (₹ Lakhs)      | 9.50                | 13.38               | 18.93               |

### 3.3 Profit & Loss Statement

#### PROFIT & LOSS STATEMENT (YEAR 1)

(All amounts in INR)

| PARTICULARS                                      | Apr            | May            | Jun            | Jul            | Aug            | Sep            | Oct            | Nov            | Dec            | Jan            | Feb            | Mar            | Total (Year 1)   |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|------------------|
| <b>INCOME</b>                                    |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                  |
| Storage Charges (₹350 per user)                  | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 58,333         | 7,00,000         |
| Transaction Fees                                 | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 12,500         | 1,50,000         |
| Premium Listings                                 | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 5,833          | 70,000           |
| Advertisements                                   | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 2,500          | 30,000           |
| <b>TOTAL REVENUE</b>                             | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>79,167</b>  | <b>9,50,000</b>  |
| <b>EXPENSES</b>                                  |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                |                  |
| Storage & Operations (Variable)                  | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -50,000        | -6,00,000        |
| Tech (Platform, App, Maintenance)                | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -5,417         | -65,000          |
| Marketing                                        | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -30,000          |
| Misc + Infrastructure                            | -16,667        | -16,667        | -16,667        | -16,667        | -16,667        | -8,333         | -8,333         | -8,333         | -8,333         | -10,833        | -10,833        | -10,833        | -2,00,000        |
| <b>TOTAL EXPENSES</b>                            | <b>-74,583</b> | <b>-74,583</b> | <b>-74,583</b> | <b>-74,583</b> | <b>-74,583</b> | <b>-66,250</b> | <b>-66,250</b> | <b>-66,250</b> | <b>-66,250</b> | <b>-68,750</b> | <b>-68,750</b> | <b>-68,750</b> | <b>-8,95,000</b> |
| <b>EARNINGS BEFORE INTEREST &amp; TAX (EBIT)</b> | <b>4,584</b>   | <b>4,584</b>   | <b>4,584</b>   | <b>4,584</b>   | <b>4,584</b>   | <b>12,917</b>  | <b>12,917</b>  | <b>12,917</b>  | <b>12,917</b>  | <b>10,417</b>  | <b>10,417</b>  | <b>10,417</b>  | <b>55,000</b>    |
| Less: Interest (Assumed)                         | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -417           | -5,000           |
| <b>PROFIT BEFORE TAX (PBT)</b>                   | <b>4,167</b>   | <b>4,167</b>   | <b>4,167</b>   | <b>4,167</b>   | <b>4,167</b>   | <b>12,500</b>  | <b>12,500</b>  | <b>12,500</b>  | <b>10,000</b>  | <b>10,000</b>  | <b>10,000</b>  | <b>10,000</b>  | <b>50,000</b>    |
| Less: Tax @ 25%                                  | -1,042         | -1,042         | -1,042         | -1,042         | -1,042         | -3,125         | -3,125         | -3,125         | -2,125         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -2,500         | -12,500          |
| <b>NET PROFIT AFTER TAX</b>                      | <b>3,125</b>   | <b>3,125</b>   | <b>3,125</b>   | <b>3,125</b>   | <b>3,125</b>   | <b>9,375</b>   | <b>9,375</b>   | <b>9,375</b>   | <b>9,375</b>   | <b>7,500</b>   | <b>7,500</b>   | <b>7,500</b>   | <b>37,500</b>    |

### 3.4 Cash Flow Statement

#### CASH FLOW STATEMENT (YEAR 1)

(All amounts in INR)

| PARTICULARS                                                 | Apr              | May             | Jun             | Jul             | Aug             | Sep             | Oct             | Nov             | Dec             | Jan             | Feb             | Mar             | TOTAL (YEAR 1)   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|------------------|
| <b>A. CASH FLOW FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES</b>               |                  |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                  |
| Net Profit Before Tax                                       | 4,167            | 4,167           | 4,167           | 4,167           | 4,167           | 12,500          | 12,500          | 12,500          | 10,000          | 10,000          | 10,000          | 10,000          | 1,00,000         |
| Add: Non-Cash Expenses (Depreciation)                       | 8,333            | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 8,333           | 1,00,000         |
| Less: Increase in Working Capital (Increase in Receivables) | -15,000          | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -15,000         | -1,80,000        |
| <b>NET CASH FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES</b>                   | <b>-2,500</b>    | <b>-2,500</b>   | <b>-2,500</b>   | <b>-2,500</b>   | <b>-2,500</b>   | <b>5,833</b>    | <b>5,833</b>    | <b>5,833</b>    | <b>3,333</b>    | <b>3,333</b>    | <b>3,333</b>    | <b>3,333</b>    | <b>23,500</b>    |
| <b>B. CASH FLOW FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES</b>               |                  |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                  |
| Purchase of Industrial Machinery                            | -5,00,000        | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -5,00,000        |
| <b>Net Cash Used in Investing Activities</b>                | <b>-5,00,000</b> | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-</b>        | <b>-5,00,000</b> |
| <b>C. CASH FLOW FROM FINANCING ACTIVITIES</b>               |                  |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                 |                  |
| Proceeds from Term Loan                                     | 10,00,000        | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | -               | 10,00,000        |
| Repayment of Term Loan (EMI)                                | -25,000          | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -25,000         | -3,00,000        |
| <b>NET CASH FROM FINANCING ACTIVITIES</b>                   | <b>9,75,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>-25,000</b>  | <b>7,00,000</b>  |
| <b>NET INCREASE / (DECREASE) IN CASH (A+B+C)</b>            | <b>4,72,500</b>  | <b>-52,500</b>  | <b>-52,500</b>  | <b>-52,500</b>  | <b>-52,500</b>  | <b>-16,667</b>  | <b>-13,333</b>  | <b>-13,333</b>  | <b>-21,667</b>  | <b>-21,667</b>  | <b>-21,667</b>  | <b>-21,667</b>  | <b>2,72,500</b>  |
| Add: Opening Cash Balance                                   | 0                | 4,72,500        | 4,20,000        | 3,67,500        | 3,15,000        | 2,62,500        | 2,45,833        | 2,32,500        | 2,19,167        | 1,97,500        | 1,75,833        | 1,54,167        | 0                |
| <b>CLOSING CASH BALANCE</b>                                 | <b>4,72,500</b>  | <b>4,20,000</b> | <b>3,67,500</b> | <b>3,15,000</b> | <b>2,62,500</b> | <b>2,45,833</b> | <b>2,32,500</b> | <b>2,19,167</b> | <b>1,97,500</b> | <b>1,75,833</b> | <b>1,54,167</b> | <b>1,32,500</b> | <b>1,32,500</b>  |

## Chapter 4: Reflections

The concept behind CampusCrate emerged from a clear and recurring challenge faced by hostel students—the lack of a safe, structured, and efficient system for buying, selling, and managing everyday items during academic transitions. Existing solutions such as informal group chats and external marketplaces often lead to inefficiencies, lack of trust, and operational issues within hostels. Our solution introduces a campus-centric marketplace integrated with a physical exchange system, designed to simplify transactions while ensuring safety, accountability, and convenience. With features such as verified users, QR-based pickups, escrow transactions, and optional storage, we aimed to address the limitations of traditional peer-to-peer exchange systems.

Working on this project has been a journey of practical learning and strategic thinking. It provided valuable exposure to real-world challenges in building a scalable platform that combines both digital and physical infrastructure. Throughout the process, we explored key aspects such as operational feasibility, cost management, user trust, and system design, while also understanding the importance of aligning our solution with user behaviour and institutional constraints.

Through surveys, discussions, and iterative refinement, we gained deeper insights into student needs and the inefficiencies in current systems. This helped us validate the demand for a structured marketplace within hostels and refine our approach accordingly. Team collaboration played a crucial role in shaping the project, as diverse perspectives contributed to stronger problem-solving, improved design decisions, and a more holistic solution.

The development of CampusCrate required us to think across multiple dimensions—technology, operations, business model, and user experience. With the continuous guidance and support of our mentor, Dr. Pravindra Kumar, we were able to approach challenges methodically, refine our strategy, and strengthen our ability to design a solution that is both practical and scalable.

Overall, this project reflects our ability to identify a real problem, design an innovative solution, and structure it into a viable system. It highlights the importance of combining technology with operational thinking and demonstrates how thoughtful design can transform everyday challenges into meaningful opportunities.



# Annexures

## 1.Opportunity canvas

| Opportunity Canvas                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Title: <u>CampusCrate</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Date: 2nd April 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Iteration: 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Users &amp; Customers</b><br><br>1.College/ University students (Freshers & Final Year)<br><br>2.Hostel Management<br><br>3.Staff & Faculty members                                                                                                                                            | <b>Problems</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Students struggle to buy/sell bulky items during hostel transitions</li> <li>No safe, structured platform for exchange</li> <li>Leads to waste, scams, clutter, and inconvenience</li> <li>Hostels face abandoned items and management issues</li> </ul> | <b>Solution Idea</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Campus-based marketplace + physical exchange hub</li> <li>Verified hostel users only</li> <li>QR-based pickup system (no direct interaction)</li> <li>Escrow payments with inspection window</li> <li>Optional storage for graduating students</li> <li>Digital record (ownership transfer)</li> </ul> | <b>How Will Users Use Your Solution?</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Seller submits item at campus hub</li> <li>Item is verified and listed on platform</li> <li>Buyer reserves and pays via app</li> <li>Buyer inspects item at pickup point</li> <li>Buyer scans QR and collects item</li> <li>Seller gets payment after confirmation</li> </ul> | <b>User Metrics</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Number of active users per hostel</li> <li>Number of transactions per semester</li> <li>Average time to sell an item</li> <li>Storage utilization rate</li> <li>User satisfaction / complaint rate</li> </ul> |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Solutions Today</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Whatsapp/ Telegram groups</li> <li>Olx/ facebook Marketplace</li> <li>Word-of-Mouth</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Adoption Strategy</b><br>1)Start with one University<br>2)Collaborate with hostel administration<br>3)Promote during semester start & end<br>4)Referral incentives for early users<br>5)Awareness via hostel groups and orientation                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Business Challenges</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Getting hostel permission and space</li> <li>Managing inventory efficiently</li> <li>Building initial trust among students</li> <li>Handling disputes and edge cases</li> <li>Maintaining usage during off-season</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Budget</b><br>Estimated Budget 5~6 LPA<br>In which:<br>Storage - 40%<br>Infra -9%(once)<br>App-12%<br>Operations-30%<br>Marketing-5%<br>Misc-4%                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Business Benefits and Metrics</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Revenue from transaction fees and storage</li> <li>Reduced hostel clutter and waste</li> <li>Improved student satisfaction</li> <li>High repeat usage across semesters</li> <li>Strong campus-level network effects</li> </ul>                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

Download at: <http://pattonassociates.com/opportunity-canvas/>



## 2.Business model canvas

### Business Model Canvas

Designed for:

CampusCrate

Designed by:

Janak, Himesh, Jasjot

Date:

14/04/2026

Version:

2.0

#### Key Partners

1. Institute administration
2. Payment gateway providers
3. Logistics/support staff

#### Motivation:

- Reduce risk (verified users)
- Optimize operations
- Access infrastructure (hostel space)

#### Key Activities

- Platform/App development
- User verification
- Managing physical exchange hub
- Payment processing (escrow)
- Inventory & logistics handling

#### Key Resources

- Mobile app & backend system
- Physical storage/exchange space
- QR system infrastructure
- Development team
- Brand & user trust
- Database (users, items, transactions)

#### Value Propositions

- Safe and trusted institute marketplace
- Scam-free transactions via escrow system
- Easy buying & selling of used/bulky items
- QR-based pickup (no direct interaction needed)
- Saves time, money, and effort
- Reduces hostel clutter & waste
- Affordable access to essential items

#### Customer Relationships

- Trust-based (verification + escrow)
- Self-service app (easy to use)
- Customer support (disputes/issues)
- Referral & incentive programs
- Community-based (hostel network)

#### Channels

- Mobile app / Web platform (primary channel)
- WhatsApp & Telegram hostel groups
- Hostel notice boards & posters
- Orientation & hostel events
- Campus ambassadors

#### Customer Segments

- Hostel students (buyers & sellers)
- First-year students (main buyers)
- Final-year students (main sellers)
- Mid-year students (both buyers & sellers)
- Hostel administration
- Faculty/staff (secondary users)

#### Cost Structure

Infrastructure (QR setup) → ₹1,50,000 (16%) (One Time Investment)  
 Storage & physical hub → ₹2,50,000/year (28%)  
 Operations (staff, logistics) → ₹3,50,000/year (39%)  
 App development & maintenance → ₹65,000/year (7.25%)  
 Marketing → ₹30,000/year (4.25%)  
 Miscellaneous → ₹50,000/year (5.5%)  
**Total Cost = ₹8,95,000/year (~9 LPA)**

#### Revenue Streams

Transaction Fee (5%) → 3000 X ₹ 50 = ₹150,000/year (15%)  
 Storage Charges → 2000 X ₹ 350 ₹700,000/year (74%)  
 Premium Listings → 200 X ₹50= ₹70,000/year (7.3%)  
 Advertisements → ₹ 30,000/year (3.7%)  
**Total Revenue = ₹9,50,000/year (~9.5 LPA)**

Designed by: The Business Model Foundry ([www.businessmodelgeneration.com/canvas](http://www.businessmodelgeneration.com/canvas)). PowerPoint implementation by: Neos Chronos Limited (<https://neoschronos.com>). License: CC BY-SA 3.0